Case Study 1 - Atari

Student submission

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Worksheet link

https://courses.ethereallab.app/assignment/v4/IT265-001-F2026/case-study-1-atari/sf463

Grading link

https://courses.ethereallab.app/assignment/v4/IT265-001-F2026/case-study-1-atari/grading/sf463

AI disclosure: Completed; 1 entry; 0 declared AI use; 1 declared no AI use; policy v1

Game Overview

Game details

Response prompt

Identify the game: title, developer, publisher, original platform, genre, and release date. Note the version you played if different.

Submitted response

The game is : Ghostbusters II developed by ACTIVISON and published by the now defunct Salu Limited and was originally released for the Atari 2600 in the year 1992 within the PAL region (Europe, Australia, New Zealand, Some of Africa and Asia)

History and industry

Response prompt

Explain the historical context of the release and where the game fit in the industry at that time.

Submitted response

This game originally developed for the movie and would coincide with the release of it in the late 1980's but as sales in the U.S. for the Atari 2600 were slowing down they saw it as a dying market and never released it in this region, while in Europe and other countries the sales of that console were not as diminishing so a later release was done as the publisher Salu had to acquired the rights then officially released it 1992. This making it so that it is one of the last produced games for this console.

Contemporary comparison

Response prompt

Compare the game with a similar game from the same period, explaining a meaningful design similarity or difference.

Submitted response

This game unlike chainsaw massacre is notoriously difficult as per what others were saying at the time the gameplay is not that self-explanatory unless the manual was read it would seem like there is no relation to the movie with the first level and design wise would be very hard to distinguish what is what in the game

Gameplay Mechanics And Level Design

Core gameplay mechanics

Response prompt

Explain how the core actions and rules shape a recurring player decision. Support the explanation with a gameplay example.

Submitted response

the core action is going deeper into the "hole" and finding parts for a ghost collecting machine and then getting

ectoplasm at the bottom and then there are ghost hands and ghost trying to stop u and cut the rope and in this part of the game the core actions are to either stop and wait for the ghost to go by, collect a vial for courage and have more of that to keep heading down if you haven't collected all the parts and then after you've collected all those then the game make you collect ectoplasm at the bottom and you load into the next level

Level design

Response prompt

Explain how the layout, obstacles, or progression affect a player decision or challenge. Use a specific example.

Submitted response

the layout is a bit randomized with ledges being the obstacles with it being short, mid, or long while the ghost either appearing as a hand or a cartoony one, there is also a pitch fork which forces you down there is also a bottle that recovers your courage and makes it so u still can go down it is like a ticking down health bar

Graphic And Audio Design

Visual design

Response prompt

Explain how a visual design choice affects the experience or communicates information during play. Use a specific example.

Submitted response

the visual design is lacking even for an Atari game as for the first level there is barely any distinction for anything in it as it is supposed to take place in a sewer I think and the second level it better as u can see the city and the hand of the statue of liberty so that one is not bad

Sound design

Response prompt

Explain how music, sound effects, or their absence affect the experience or communicate information during play. Use a specific example.

Submitted response

the sound are just fine, they are distinct enough to know what something is and what something else isn't

Narrative And Storytelling

Narrative and setting

Response prompt

Explain how the setting and story relate to play. Describe key events if present, or explain the effect of a limited or absent story.

Submitted response

there is no good narrative and story telling in this game as even if it was based off the movie it does not resemble any of the real events of the story

Character development

Response prompt

Explain how character development relates to gameplay, or how limited or absent development affects the experience.

Submitted response

there is none as to progress the levels is just to proceed and there is not much to think about as the game is very linear in it's approach

Impact And Reception

Reception

Response prompt

Summarize the critical and player reception using identifiable reviews or feedback.
Distinguish release-era reception from later reactions.

Submitted response

it was seen as very difficult and not much of a good game but is now a valued as since not many copies were made this is sought after highly by some collectors

Industry and cultural impact

Response prompt

Explain the game's industry impact and cultural significance using research. Avoid claiming influence that the sources do not establish.

Submitted response

there is not much impact it had when it released other then it was seen as difficult but in today's climate it is seen as a collector item and has some rarity to it so it is seen as a valuable item rather then a fun game now

Reflection

Fun and experience

Response prompt

Explain what made the game enjoyable or frustrating for you, using a gameplay example.

Submitted response

it was very frustrating cause the controls are clunky and felt like there was a lot of latency in it could have been the emulator but who know cause either way it felt non-responsive and the objective isn't made very clear at all

Learning and research

Response prompt

Reflect on what this case study taught you and how easy or difficult it was to find dependable information.

Submitted response

it wasn't too hard to find information but there were many scatter piece in different places like the wiki page on this didn't have any sources and the Atari online is a little too vague on the information but very useful. The You-tube video play-though made me know that there was a second level. This taught me that video games have become a lot more standardized and more accessible then I care to admit